

Liang (Leon) Fang

Email: liang.fang0611@gmail.com | Tel: +1-949-735-3140

EDUCATION

Duke University, Fuqua School of Business

7/2021–5/2022

M.S. in Management Studies

GPA: 3.6/4.0

- Main Curriculum: Corporate Finance, Marketing Research, Principles of Strategy, Quantitative Analysis, Modeling

University of California, Irvine

9/2016–6/2020

B.A. in Economics (Cum Laude Honor); B.A. in Fine Arts

GPA: 3.7/4.0

- Main Curriculum: Econometrics, Managerial Econ, Probability and Stats, Business Economic, International Econ

SKILLS & INTERESTS

Research Interests: Entrepreneurship, Startup/VC Finance, AI & Tech Innovations, Organization, Startup Strategy

Technical and Programming Skills: R, Python, Stata, CrystalBall, Tableau, Google Analysis, LaTeX

Tests: GRE 333: Verbal: 163, Quant: 170

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Northwestern University, Kellogg School of Management

REMOTE

Research Assistant (Supervisor: Prof. Kylie Jiwon Hwang)

1/2026–Current

- Supported empirical research at the intersection of entrepreneurship, labor market reintegration, and employment discrimination, examining hiring outcomes & entrepreneurial entry among incarcerated individuals.
- Collected and merged multi-source datasets including county-level unemployment records, BTB policy adoption data, and geographic location variables; performed data cleaning, variable construction, and sample stratification using Stata to analyze how employer demand-side behavior varies across labor market contexts.
- Developed and maintained analytical scripts in Stata for regression analysis and spatial data processing; produced research documentation and formatted output tables using LaTeX.

Harvard Business School, Laboratory for Innovation Science

REMOTE

Research Assistant (Supervisor: Prof. Jacqueline Lane, Prof. Shai Bernstein)

12/2025–Current

- Co-worked a cross-region founder survey experiment comparing venture “problem statements” across the U.S., Europe, and China; contributed to sampling strategy, questionnaire logic, and analysis-ready variable design.
- Helped qualitative data collection, recruited and screened early-stage founders, conducted 25+ semi-structured interviews, and extracted standardized problem statements to calibrate survey items and validate cross-cultural comparability.
- Built an AI research pipeline, developed and iterated LLM workflows to generate/normalize venture problem statements from public signals; implemented automated web data collection (crawler/scraping) and structured datasets for triangulation against founder-reported responses.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Hangzhou IC Innovation Centre

Hangzhou, China

Manager, Incubation Department

1/2024–12/2025

A government-supported incubation platform in Hangzhou, dedicated to incubating early-stage ventures in Integrated Circuits and AI. The centre facilitates regional tech growth through financial advising, VC connection, subsidy implementation, and infrastructure support.

- **Incubation Management:** led the startup sourcing and incubation operations of 100+ startups through direct outreach, demo day scouting, and university tech partnerships; vetted and recruited 11 start-ups, exceeding annual target by 40%.
- **Funding Connection:** Facilitated connections between startups and SOE-affiliated strategic investors, providing 50+ pitch coaching and data room curation. Contributed to 9 successful follow-on funding cases totaling \$1.5M+.
- **Policy Analysis:** Authored 3 comprehensive research reports on AI entrepreneurship subsidies, analyzing policies across all government levels and parks in Hangzhou.

ZhenFund

Beijing, China

Post-Investment Specialist

2/2023–10/2023

ZhenFund is consistently ranked #1 in China's premier angel investment in the early-stage sector. Co-founded in partnership with Sequoia China and managing approximately \$5B AUM.

- **Fundraising & Capital Introductions:** Sourced and matched follow-on financing for portfolio companies by connecting them with local SOE/industrial capital and later-stage VC/PE investors; conducted 300+ investor/resource introductions and helped facilitate ~US\$8M in cumulative funding outcomes.
- **LP Development:** Supported fundraising by mapping regional government-guided funds (FOFs) and LPs; organized multiple roadshows and deal-matching sessions, coordinating outreach, materials, and follow-ups to advance LP pipeline development.
- **Government Relationships:** Assisted portfolio companies with government relations and public-facing positioning by arranging official visits, policy endorsement briefings, and media exposure; strengthened compliance readiness and external credibility for companies pursuing regulated milestones (e.g., IPO-related approvals).

Triangle Education Technology

Beijing, China

Co-Founder and CMO

9/2020-1/2023

Co-founded K12 education planning firm combining financial literacy + study-path advising; scaled to US\$1M+ revenue and exited in 2023.

- **Led product design and growth:** defined user personas, learning modules (communication, finance/econ foundations), and engagement mechanisms; executed 20+ campaigns/events, growing social followers by 30,000+ and strengthening top-of-funnel traffic.
- **Product Oversight:** Led product design and growth experiments: defined user personas, learning modules (work habits, communication, finance/econ foundations), and engagement mechanisms; executed 20+ campaigns/events, growing social followers by 30,000+ and strengthening top-of-funnel traffic, launched APP-based curriculum and lifecycle marketing; generated 2,000+ leads, converted 200+ clients, and drove US\$1M revenue in two years.
- **Marketing Strategy:** designed acquisition strategy (content/ads/communities), pricing and conversion playbooks, and CRM/KPI systems; recruited and led a 5-person marketing & sales team with training and performance management.

RESEARCH PROJECTS

“Navigating the Labyrinth: A Framework Analysis of Municipal Subsidy Policies for AI Entrepreneurship in Hangzhou”

Researcher, Hangzhou IC Innovation Centre

3/2025-5/2025

- Designed and executed an AI government subsidy policy analysis, systematically collecting and coding 50+ policy documents from municipal, district (e.g., Yuhang, Binjiang), and science park-level authorities.
- Authored a 25-page strategic report that identified critical gaps in funding allocation, highlighting inconsistencies in application barriers that disproportionately affect non-elite founders.

“Z-Bench: A Novel Framework for Benchmarking the Practical Utility of LLMs”

Research Leader, ZhenFund

5/2023-7/2023

- Designed and executed a rigorous benchmarking study immediately following the public release of GPT-4 to quantify its capabilities against predecessors like GPT-3.5 and open-source models (e.g., LLaMA-7B).
- Curated and aggregated 'Z-Bench,' a novel evaluation suite of 1,000+ prompts across four distinct domains: Quantitative Reasoning: (e.g., problems sourced from the MATH dataset); Logical Puzzles & Brain Teasers: (e.g., Wason selection tasks, lateral thinking puzzles); Chinese Language Nuance: (e.g., Chengyu interpretation, classical poetry analysis); Factual Accuracy: (e.g., fact-checking prompts sourced from TriviaQA).

“Why Didn’t Indie Studios Disrupt AI-Driven Game Design? Evidence from Organizational Capabilities and Compute Constraints”

Research Leader, ZhenFund

5/2023-7/2023

- Conducted an in-depth analysis of the AI + gaming industry, delineating the development stages of gaming and AI's interrelationship. Investigated how AI technologies have been instrumental in enhancing gaming performance.
- Explored the technical facets of AI integration within gaming, encompassing areas such as deep-reinforced-learning, articulation networks, and mesh-based tracking.

Market Research Capstone Project (Supervisor: Prof. Allison J.B. Chaney)

Acquisition advisory for a game developing company based on quantitative research

2/2022 - 5/2022

- Utilized Python for web scraping gaming information and applied R for regression analysis to evaluate the optimal acquisition of the most promising one from three potential games.
- Researched customer surveys on potential games, performed conjoint analysis to assess player Willingness to Pay based on their affinity and purchase intent. Analyzed player preferences in RPG niches using K-means clustering, cross-tabulation.

“Alcohols for Z-Generations; research, product mapping, and valuations”

Researcher, DT Capital Partners

8/2020-12/2020

- Conducted an in-depth study of the evolutionary trajectory of Chinese alcohol markets, highlighting the diverse categories of alcohol and their respective developmental stages, outputted 55 pages report.
- Implemented market trend forecasts for young adult alcohol consumption, leveraging a comprehensive survey of 100 individuals to gauge consumption patterns, preferences, and market inclination.

INTERNSHIP EXPERIENCE

DT Capital Partners (Top-30 PE in China)

Shanghai, China

Analyst Intern

2/2021–5/2021

- **Dealt sourcing:** Dealt sources and conducted interviews with 40+ business founders and engaged in customer interviews of startups to gather pivotal information to partners.
- **Industry Research:** Conducted two industry research on the consumer sector, included analysis of market trends, consumer behaviors, competitive landscape, and emerging opportunities.

Bytedance

Beijing, China

Strategy Intern

10/2020-2/2021

- Initiated Google Analytics and Oracle database to conduct data-driven analysis on product performance, generating strategic insights and recommendations for Feishu official website, which generated 13% increase in user growth.
- Managed the "Growth Plan" marketing project for Feishu, resulted in the generation of more than 200 Marketing Qualified Leads (MQLs) which subsequently converted into 10+ tenant acquisitions.